

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 7 2
 ♥ Q 10 4 3
 ♦ A J 9 2
 ♣ Q 7 3

♠ 10 9 8 6 5 3

♥ K 7

♦ 8 4

♣ A K J



♠ A 4

♥ J 9 5

♦ K 10 7 5

♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ K Q J

♥ A 8 6 2

♦ Q 6 3

♣ 10 9 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Don't think of passing. With 11 HCP and 2 length points you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What is your next bid?

You must bid and you want to show that you have a bare minimum. You don't want to say 2NT because of that doubleton nothing ♦. So you rebid your 6-card ♠ suit. Partner bids 4 ♠ and everybody passes.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ 5 on which you play dummy's ♦ 3. West wins ♦ J, plays ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ 5 on which you play dummy's ♦ 3. West wins ♦ J, plays ♦ A, then ♦ 2.

You have already lost the 2 ♦ s and you sure can't escape losing the Ace of trumps. So you mustnot lose a ♣ trick. So your Plan will be to pull trumps, then finesse West for the ♣ Q.

You ruff the third ♦, play ♠ s until the ♠ A appears. When you regain the lead you pull any outstanding trumps, play one high ♣, (in case someone has a singleton ♣ Q), then enter dummy with the ♥ A and make the ♣ finesse. Half of the time you make the contract, the other half you don't.

You were lucky that the ♣ Q was with West.

It's never great when the success of your contract depends on a finesse, but sometimes that's your only hope - a 50% chance.

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 6 4

♥ Q 7

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ K Q 7 6

♠ A 7

♥ K 6 5 3

♦ 7 6 2

♣ 10 5 4 3



♠ K Q 10 3

♥ A 4

♦ Q J 10 5

♣ A J 2

♠ 9 8 5 2

♥ J 10 9 8 2

♦ K 4

♣ 9 8

West

North

East

South

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Your only hope is to win 8 more tricks before you lose the lead. That means the ♦ finesse had better work. At trick 2 you lead your ♦ Q, playing low from dummy if South doesn't cover. Repeat the finesse as necessary. When South has the ♦ K you will make your contract, and when North has the ♦ K you will go down. That's a 50% chance, just like most finesses. But remember, if you had tried to establish the ♠ suit instead of taking the finesse your chance of making 3NT would be 0%.

You can see what could have happened if you had tried to sneak even one ♠ trick. North would have grabbed the ♠ A and played a small ♥. South would have happily taken 4 ♥ tricks and you would be down 1.

You have a very solid 17 points and a balanced hand. You open 1NT. Partner responds 3NT and you pass.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥ J. You hopefully put on the ♥ Q, but North plays the ♥ K.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥ J. You hopefully put on the ♥ Q, but North plays the ♥ K.

Winners: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 4 : Total = 6

A hold-up won't help unless North had a doubleton ♥, giving South a 7-card suit. So you win your ♥ A. The ♠ suit is solid after the ♠ A is played, but before you could enjoy those 3 tricks the defenders would have really enjoyed a bunch of ♥ s.